

Beat

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ABSTRACT

The Story Incubated from Your heartbeats.

Concept: You can share your own heartbeat with a robot, and you can feel its growth together.

Main Character: A robot boy called “Maruboro” honest robot, who is not yet familiar with “life”.

He has been left in an old factory quietly. One day, the viewer comes over and gives his/her heart as life to him.⁷

Viewers can project themselves into the characters and enjoy the story.

Logline: The viewer gives his/her heart to Maruboro and breathes a life into him. Maruboro wants to become friends with another robot called Kakuboro, but Maruboro doesn’t know how to interact with others. It makes Kakuboro angry.

However, Maruboro desperately wants to make friends and he starts to think from Kakuboro’s point of view. Kakuboro finally opens up his heart to Maruboro.

Story: “Beat” is a story elaborated from your “Heart”.

Viewers can experience the work with their hearts in their hands. The heart in the animation vibrates at the same pace at viewers’ heartbeat.

The setting of the story is an old factory. Viewers encounter a rusted robot called Maruboro, it was absolutely static.

He doesn’t have a “heart” to move.

Viewers can grant Maruboro a new heart by putting theirs on the robot.

He then stands up and starts to move, expressing joy to live out all his strength.

Maruboro looks a little lonely. When he finds that other robots open their hearts and connect with each other, he starts to search for friends.

However, when Maruboro meets with new robots, he doesn’t know how to communicate properly.

He tries to open up his heart to another robot called Kakuboro. While in Maruboro’s disturbance, Kakuboro dropped an important component of his factory.

Kakuboro becomes angry and tries to get rid of Maruboro. He broke Maruboro’s heart accidentally.

Maruboro is so depressed, but he tries to work with the viewer to search for the lost component.

Finally, Maruboro finds it and give that back to Kakuboro. Kakuboro uses that to run the factory.

The factory then starts to operate and sets off big fireworks.

The hearts of the two robots eventually come together. Maruboro’s heart starts to beat again.

“Heart” becomes the key to move the story forward.

The story aims to arouse consciousness of “Heart” via the growth of the robot.

KEYWORDS

We hope viewers can realize that their heart has the “power of life”, “power to connect with others”, and “power to think of others”

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1 DIRECTOR: KEISUKE ITOH

VR animation director. Graduated from Tama Art University, Department of Graphic Design. After working as a graphic designer for a manufacturing company, he became a freelance CGI artist in 2012. In 2020/2021, Beat was nominated for the competition section of the 77th Venice International Film Festival and Cannes XR. In 2019, Feather was premiered at the 76th Venice International Film Festival in a Biennale College Selection as the first Japanese film in the VR category. In addition, his works have been screened at numerous film festivals, including the Berlin International Film Festival, Busan International Film Festival, Kaohsiung Film Festival, and SIGGRAPH.

1.1 Screening History

- 4• Venice International Film Festival
- 4• Piccolo Grande Cinema
- 4• Beyond the Frame Festival
- 4• Beyond the Frame Festival in China
- 4• Xi’an Art and Tech Festival
- 4• MIFA Expanded Animation (VIPO)
- 4• Beyond Reality BIFAN
- 4• Cannes XR

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- 4• Cannes XR in China
- 4• SIGGRAPH
- 4• XR CREATIVE AWARD 2021
- 4• Bucharest International Dance Film Festival 2021

- 4• Zlin Film Fest
- 4• Vancouver International Film Festival
- 4• 4K VR映画祭2021
- 4• SANDBOX IMMERSIVE FESTIVAL